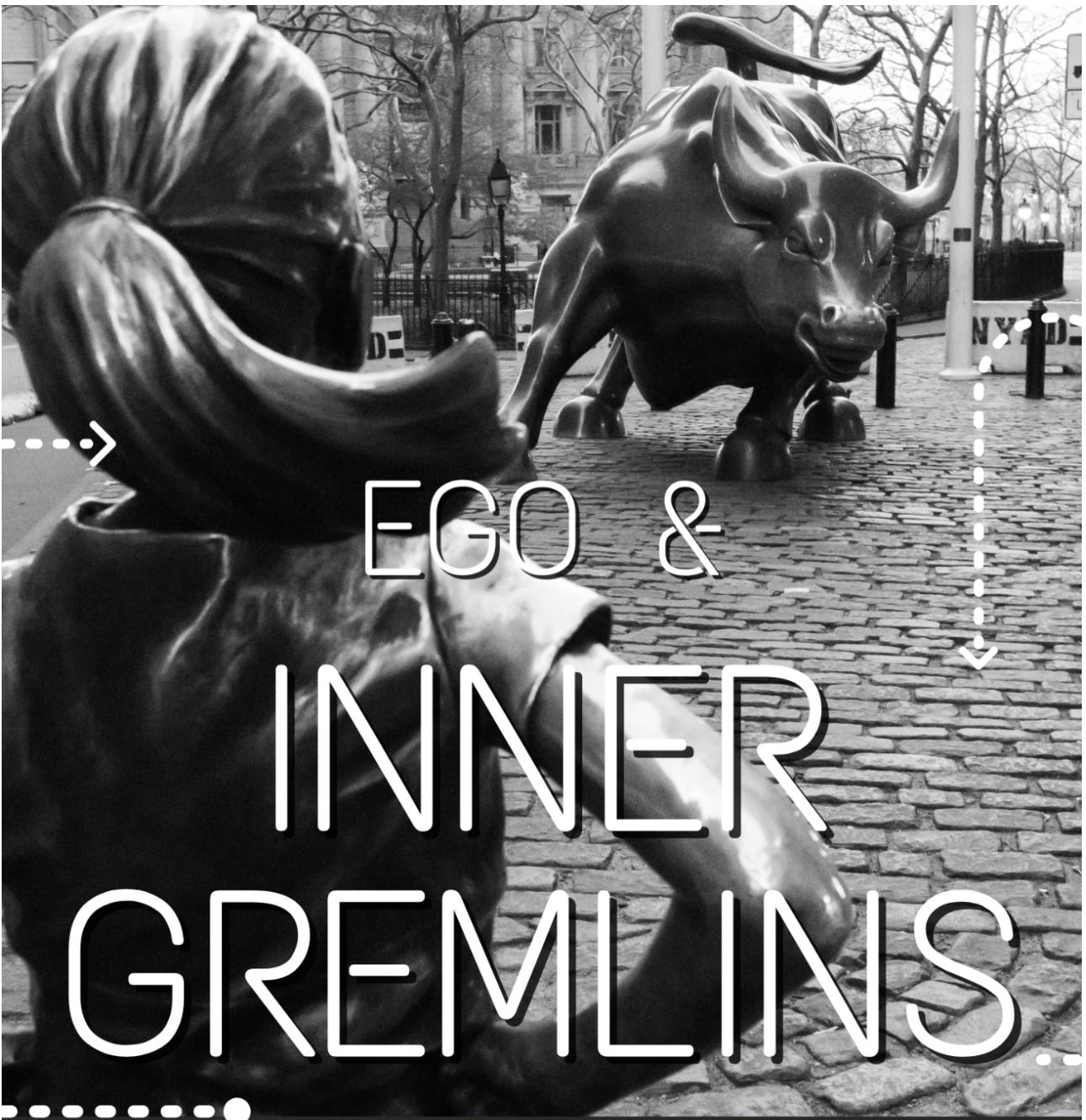


A black and white photograph of the Wall Street Bull statue in New York City. In the foreground, the back of a person's head with long hair tied in a bun is visible, looking towards the bull. The bull is in the middle ground, facing right. The background shows a cobblestone street, trees, and buildings. The title "EGO & INNER GREMLINS" is overlaid in large, white, sans-serif capital letters. Decorative dotted lines with arrowheads are present: one on the left pointing right, one on the right pointing down, and one at the bottom left pointing right.

EGO & INNER GREMLINS

How Your Emotions
Impact Your Trading

by

KIM ANN CURTIN

THE WALL STREET COACH

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Introduction

Are emotions a trader's worst enemy?

It's a straightforward question ... But the answer isn't so simple.

On the one hand, it's tempting to believe that trading 'like a machine' would result in far better outcomes. No emotions, no mistakes — right?

Unfortunately, there are a few problems with that approach. For one, traders are human beings. They can't avoid feeling emotions.

Second, emotions don't always lead traders astray. They can offer traders valuable information that can help them to learn and grow.

Emotions become problematic when they rule a trader's decisions.

Most people don't make the most rational decisions under emotional duress. Add money to the mix and it only compounds the effect.

Everyone deals with shame, judgment, fear of missing out (FOMO), and their own inner critics differently. When traders are ruled by their ego and "inner gremlins," it can lead to poor decision-making, losses, and a cycle of self-blame.

Thankfully, there are ways for traders to practice discipline to help deal with these feelings and tame those gremlins so that they don't have an adverse impact.

Rather than attempting to shut off their emotions, I propose that the trader's real work is to know and understand them.

By getting curious and inquisitive, it becomes possible to get to know and observe these emotions and their effects. These are vital steps to keeping emotions in check.

Ready to get curious?

This book will guide you through the process of identifying and beginning to understand how your ego and inner gremlins may have an impact on your trading.

From there, you'll learn actionable ways to tend to those emotions in a constructive manner. You'll learn how to be self-aware and realize when it is your gremlins talking and not you.

Will understanding how ego and inner gremlins affect trading make you a better trader?

That's up to you. Understanding how emotions play into trading may not instantly change the trajectory of your trading. But it can help you identify the roadblocks that may be holding you back so that you can begin to work on removing them.

This can help you avoid falling prey to FOMO or making panic-fueled decisions with large amounts of money.

It can also help you develop better discipline when it comes to actually sticking with your carefully crafted trading plan and avoiding self-blame if things go wrong.

The goal of this book is to help traders gain a better understanding of themselves so they can get around what is holding them back.

Chapter One: Your Ego and Inner Gremlins

What exactly are “inner gremlins”?

Gremlins are mischievous folkloric creatures. They’re often depicted as strange-looking creatures with spiky backs, claws, and sharp teeth. You’ve probably seen them in movies — they do things like cause airplane malfunctions.

The gremlins I’m talking about in this book are causing malfunctions — but not to machinery. They’re sabotaging us emotionally, from the inside out. They’re keeping us from finding equanimity.

Your personal inner gremlins can make your life a living hell. They start their sentences with their favorite words like "should" "would" and "could" ... Their voices are so persistent that we often confuse them with our personal truth.

Imagine a school bus being driven by a wayward child instead of an adult. That's what gremlins do. They hijack your own emotional well being and often unconsciously drive you instead of letting you take the steering wheel.

Gremlins make you feel bad about yourself. They make you feel ashamed. They make you feel unworthy. They aren't encouraging although they convince you most times you'd be lost without them. They are crafty and subtle.

The sooner you realize they are running in the background of your life, the quicker you'll be able to unplug from their directives. They may not ever go away completely. But they will lose their power once you have them named and know that which triggers them.

To begin, you need to think about a few things...

- In what way does your ego impact your trading?
- Are you more concerned about how you will be perceived than how to improve your trades?
- How do your emotions play into your decision making?
- What leads those emotions?
- Is it fact or is it your self-deprecating inner gremlin speaking?

The first thing you should do to identify behaviors that are holding you back is take a step into a place of neutrality and curiosity.

Think about it: when you are feeling down, how much motivation do you have to really make a change? Probably not a lot. The feelings of depression and hardship weigh you down. This can make it nearly impossible to move forward.

When you're in this space, it's easy to retract from the things that matter and begin to resist change, even if it is positive.

Observing yourself judgmentally all the time is depleting. You probably won't get where you want to be by being constantly critical of yourself.

Think about swimmers in a competition. Why do they shave before a meet? It's to eliminate the "drag" that the hair on their body creates that can potentially hold them back.

As a trader, you're attempting to reduce that drag and to shave off the emotions that are holding you back. But don't worry — no razor is necessary to do this emotional work.

Sometimes, these inner gremlins can become deeply embedded in your psyche.

For example, if you made a trade that cost you a substantial amount of money, you may continue to think about it for years to come. It may feel impossible to move past such a loss. But in truth, it's most likely your inner critic saying that.

Inner gremlins can make losses and mistakes feel like much more than they actually are.

Once again, it's worth getting curious. What is it that you are making that loss mean to you and your life as a whole?

Is the continued weight of that loss doing you any favors?

Most likely, continuing to carry that story and weight is working against you. The loss doesn't need to have a deeper meaning.

Taking your thoughts to a place of neutrality will remove you from the place of blame and instead focus your thoughts on situations, feelings, and behaviors that occurred.

Instead of dwelling on the past, think about what you want to do moving forward. How is that loss impacting your ability to do that?

Coping with bad decisions

Coping with bad decisions requires a little bit of constructive self-analysis.

What specific events trigger you to buy or sell a stock? Examine the emotions behind that decision and determine if they are valid or not.

Some traders are able to step into a neutral headspace when it comes to deciding when to pull out of a stock or when to power through.

This is crucial to maintaining a healthy mindset as a day trader. But if you're not at that place yet, how can you get there?

For some traders, it can help to establish a set of rules before a trade.

For example, you may want to set a predetermined loss threshold that you are comfortable with before you enter the trade. Once that pain point is hit, you admit you're wrong and exit. Having an established plan can help you stay disciplined and keep the loss from getting personal.

Of course, that's easier said than done. Those inner gremlins might still be telling you that loss means the world.

That's why it's also important to identify go-to coping techniques that you can count on to improve your mood.

Finding what makes you feel better — or at least takes your mind off things — can help you find that all-important place of neutrality.

Maybe it's hitting the gym. Maybe it's reading a book. Maybe it's something else entirely. Consider ways you might be able to “reset” and better deal with the decisions that are causing you emotional pain.

Additionally, take the time to consider how you can avoid triggering situations that lead to bad trading decisions.

For instance, if you observe that you made a trading blunder right after you had a fight with your significant other, that can inform you in the future. Moving forward, you might want to avoid speculative trades right after any emotional discussions. Remember — this isn't about blame or regret. It's about gaining the ability to approach trading from a neutral standpoint.

When you find yourself upset about a choice you made, take the time to really consider why you are so bothered by it.

You may feel like you've lost the entire world in one failed trade. But in reality, the whole world probably isn't crumbling — maybe just a small portion of it. When you step back and look at the situation from a place of neutrality, it's easier to see that.

For many traders, a forward-moving mindset can help to overcome these negative thoughts. Instead of focusing on one, small fleeting moment, they shift their focus to a bigger and longer-term goal.

For some, it may be mentally moving on to the next potential trade. Others may need to focus on something completely unrelated for a day or two and come back to trading with a refreshed mindset.

Regardless of your chosen technique, it will take time and continued practice to start seeing positive effects.

Silencing that inner critic reminding you of everything you could have done differently is hard. It requires taking a pause to reflect on what is really important and to be honest about what is actually true.

For instance, if you feel like you are a loser, ask yourself, “Is that really true?” Probably not — it’s your inner critic. The story those gremlins are telling is not the truth but a perspective of reality.

Imagine a busload of rowdy children, all talking at the same time. Essentially, this is what is happening during your inner dialogue. There is a lot of background noise, but very little value in what you hear. Most of the time, that inner saboteur is saying things like, “You aren’t getting anywhere” or “You could have done so much better.” When you’re hearing that sort of noise 24 hours a day, you may start to accept it as fact.

For many of us, these inner gremlins have been around so long that they practically have squatter’s rights. It’s hard to get them out. After a while, it can be hard to make a distinction between the voice of the inner gremlins and your actual voice.

That’s why it’s so important to make a point to stop and question that inner saboteur. Question what their definition of what a loss really is and how those thoughts are impacting your ability to look at the big picture.

Often, your inner critic’s definition of a trading loss transcends money and goes into personal territory. It is screaming at you that you did everything wrong instead of providing useful information. It’s only when you look at that inner gremlin’s perspective and question it from a neutral perspective you will begin to pull useful information out of the situation.

Think about a scientist at work. When they perform experiments, they don't favor one outcome over the other. They're observers and recorders of data.

Could you use that as an example of how to look at negative emotions in your life? Try to observe different outcomes as if you were a scientist. Make notes of how your emotions drive your trading decisions and vice versa. Be an observer and nothing more.

Looking at your own personal "data" in this way can also help you identify your positive traits and coping mechanisms and how you might be able to use them when you trade.

For instance, if you typically use humor to deal with things, consider how that might be able to help you in tough situations. Is there something about a trading mistake that you can laugh about in retrospect? Finding a humorous angle could help you move forward instead of harping on the loss. That's just one example — finding the funny side isn't for everyone. The point is more about finding a positive coping technique that works for you and puts you in a better mindset.

Another helpful exercise is to consider the external sources that have a positive impact on your mentality. Trading can be a lonely profession — many traders find that online forums or trading communities can provide an uplifting sense of community. All traders have experienced a few losses. Chatting and swapping trading stories with like-minded individuals can help normalize losses and help you put things in perspective.

Everyone's different. The techniques that get you in a good mindset won't be the same as every other trader. That's why it's so important to get

curious about your personal needs so that you can begin to actually meet them.

It's worth taking the time to do this. If your outside needs are not being met, your emotions can take over. You can feel like you're drowning in feelings. That's not the best playing field for making the most calculated and educated decisions in trades ... It's all too easy to give in to your inner critic at such times.

Most inspiring stories start with an obstacle that had to be overcome. It's within your power to choose to transform a trading loss into a long-term positive learning experience. It's also within your power to let a trading loss become the worst thing that's ever happened in your life. What kind of story do you want to tell with your actions and reactions? It all starts with your ability to address that voice within yourself and see how it is really impacting your life.

How much of your life do you want to be dictated by your inner critic? How might things be different if you began to challenge it? When you step back and examine your own toxic thoughts, you may discover they have been holding you back more than you realized.

Chapter Two: Neutrality in Your Thinking

Now that you have a better understanding of what your inner gremlins are and how they work in tandem with your ego to impact your trades, how can you begin to gain control?

It's simple. You need to reach neutrality in your thinking.

Simple — but not easy.

Not sure where to get started? Here's an example. Say that you messed up on a trade, and you know you've got a tendency to dwell on how you messed up. When you find yourself in a situation like this, you can start by rerouting your thinking to what forces led to that decision.

If possible, avoid making it personal. When you start making trading decisions part of your identity, it can chip away at your soul.

Think back to the last time you had a bad day or a bad trading week. Instead of plowing forward, did you harbor feelings of worthlessness? How did it affect your state of mind, your relationship with others, and your sense of self-esteem?

When you do not maintain neutrality in your thoughts, you often wind up punishing yourself in ways that are not proportionate to the actual loss.

At that point, it has less to do with trading and more to do with your personal coping style.

Information from your past trading experiences leaves an impression on your brain. These experiences can be valuable learning tools — if you're able to separate feelings from facts.

It's easy to hold on to the emotional stress from past experiences. Over time, this can begin to drive future decisions in toxic ways.

That's why learning how to consciously unplug from what that data is telling you and addressing the environment within yourself is key.

Take a step back and consider a trading decision that really weighed on you for a long time.

Are you able to verbalize what about the decision bothered you?

Often, it's a process of internalizing what went wrong, and making it about you instead of looking at the situation factually.

For instance, common reactions might include "If I had traded sooner, I would not be in this position" or "I could have bought that stock and made a ton of money."

These thoughts are very human, but they really don't accomplish much.

On the contrary, thoughts like this only form a groove in your brain that can dent your self-esteem and confidence. Over time, you may even find that negativity paralyzes you from making any decisions at all.

That is why neutralizing your thinking is so important. When you're able to get to an unbiased headspace and separate your decisions from your

emotions or ego, you can make more educated and fact-based trading decisions.

Many of us like to think in black-and-white terms. Neutrality in thinking is a grey area. But that's not a bad thing.

In a high-pressure situation, maintaining an objective headspace can improve your ability to approach the problem at hand in a reasonable manner.

As a trader, you can use neutral thinking to leave your own judgment behind and move forward by removing biases, both internal and external.

Ask yourself, what would it take for you to make each trade indifferent or less personal? The answer is different for everyone. Usually, the answer parallels how you cope with other bad situations.

In some cases, people use humor or they put their energy into a new project. Determine what your go-to coping mechanism is and identify how you can use it in your trades.

One of the biggest obstacles is getting your conscious voice to be louder than the voice inside of you that's trying to beat you down. That voice has likely been there for a long time and is the culmination of learned behavior and experiences. It's hard to talk over it ... But it's possible.

Inner gremlins and internal bias are part of human nature. Everyone alters reality a little bit. But it becomes problematic when this altered reality impacts your ability to achieve goals and see things clearly.

Pushing that inner critic out and allowing room for neutral thinking can benefit you in numerous ways. But how do you go about addressing those toxic inner thoughts?

Addressing negative thoughts

Our inner dialogue can have a powerful impact on how we see the world.

For instance, many people think to themselves, “I *have* to” instead of “I *get* to.” A simple reframe can completely change the meaning of how we think.

This concept can be applied in trading, too. For instance, if you have a loss, you might automatically think, “Man, I really messed that one up.”

But what if instead, you looked back at the loss and thought “What led to this decision and how can I avoid it in the future?” This sort of simple mindset shift can help you enable yourself to move forward instead of staying hung up on negative thoughts.

Kicking negative thoughts to the curb is easier said than done. First and foremost, it’s necessary to confront whatever inner gremlins are holding you back. Identify them. Name them if you have to. Determine how they have impacted your life.

Put some thought into what emotions might hinder you from moving forward. Get curious — put them under the microscope. If you know yourself to be someone who constantly worries and hangs on bad decisions for a long time, try to figure out why.

Ask yourself: Why am I having these thoughts? How do these feelings help me? If they do not help you, try to verbalize how they are holding you

back. For example, if a bad trade sent you into a downward spiral and made you feel like you couldn't trust your experience or decisions, your thought patterns are not helping you.

It's also important to take responsibility for your own patterns. Many traders are quick to blame outside factors, such as a volatile market or the unrealistic expectations of others.

Trading can be stressful. But that's mainly because of the emotions you have tied to your win or loss.

When it comes down to it, the only person putting those expectations out there is you. Take those feelings and thoughts and move them out of your way.

Moving those feelings out of the way introduces one of the biggest challenges in trading — maybe even in life. You have to be painfully honest with yourself. You have to become more self-conscious of your day-to-day decisions without beating yourself up.

The heart of that is being aware. Being awake. Many traders tie their personal value and worth in their profits and losses. In many cases, this ties into their own opinions of themselves as well. Your net worth does not equate to your self-worth. Instead, traders should strive to take losses in stride and not internalize them.

Different people will handle this differently. For some people, it's helpful to maintain a sense of humor through hard times. Others need to focus their energy on the next big thing. Determine what works for you so that you are not focused on your inner saboteur's dialogue.

Think about a time period when your inner dialogue got the best of you. Try to remember everything you can about that day, or days, but look at it from a place of neutrality instead of a place where emotions control your thoughts.

Think about how you could have brought your sense of humor or focus to the situation and how it could have helped you rather than focusing on what your inner critic was saying.

Practicing neutrality can help you prepare for trying situations in the future.

Next time you have a loss, listen for that inner gremlin to pipe up and strongly question it. Question its origin. Question why you value that voice. Is there a personal story attached to it? How might that experience be impacting your way of thinking?

Most of the time balancing your thoughts and finding a neutral stance takes about two minutes or less. Two minutes could help save you a world of self doubt and self-inflicted mental pain. When you take the time to question those voices beating you down, you will realize they don't have a leg to stand on. Once you've attained that neutral stance, you can begin developing positive coping techniques and positive traits to improve your mindset.

Chapter Three: Identify Positive Traits

The ability to identify and focus on positive traits and experiences can help traders push down the negativity of those nasty inner gremlins.

It's all too easy to focus on what you're doing wrong ... So take it slow, and be gentle with yourself. Consider what you do well and how those things can be carried over into your trading. Think about the trades that have gone well for you and how your positive traits contributed to that success.

Everyone has the natural ability to adapt and overcome. If you're having trouble identifying positive traits, you can start there.

We are all gifted in the sense that we can navigate through challenges and survive them.

The tough part is that every situation is different. It's not always possible to deal with every challenge in the same way. So why do so many of us try to approach different situations with the same set of reactions? It is learned behavior. We have all adapted to our surroundings repeatedly over the course of our lives, starting from childhood. How have those experiences transferred over into your adult life? How are they impacting your trading decisions and how you act now?

When considering questions like this, do not go into a place of judgment. It is important to remain neutral and look for a way to bring curiosity to the situation.

Here's an example of how you can apply this to trading. If a trade goes poorly, think about every emotion that led to the situation. Maybe you were having a bad day. Maybe you were hungry. Maybe you weren't feeling physically well. Instead of the self-blame game, get curious about what drives certain behaviors and how it impacts your decision-making process and trades.

It is both a test and a task to step back and look at yourself with more curiosity than judgment. Putting on the lens of curiosity can help you notice things you haven't before. Not only can it help you pinpoint some of the things holding you back, but it can also help you identify positive traits and characteristics.

Consider a time you felt bad about yourself or a decision you made. When you're in that space, you're depleted — and everything seems like it takes a lot more effort. It's easy to go into a place of resistance.

At such times, observing yourself with judgment will only lead to feelings of shame that can immobilize you. Getting comfortable with your humanity is a vital step to transforming yourself and your trading.

Focusing on what is important

In general, people are extremely hard on themselves. Sometimes, we even criticize ourselves for being too hard on ourselves! It can be a never-ending cycle.

Stepping into a place of curiosity and neutral thinking helps break that cycle so you can get to a place where you can focus on what is really important.

Think of this as a method of looking at the big picture. It's easy to focus on little things and forget that big picture — especially in the world of day trading. Every trade looms large in your mind as you're in it. Losses can seem extremely dire — but are they really, over time?

Truly focusing on what's important goes beyond just looking at the bigger picture. It's about questioning the voice telling you what your loss means.

Question that perspective and try to approach it with a sense of inquiry. Get down to the bottom of why that loss meant so much to you. This will serve a more positive purpose than beating yourself up about how you messed up.

To question your inner gremlin, pause for a moment and ask yourself if the story they are telling is actually true. For instance, say you just had a trading loss and you're really beating yourself up about it. Is this loss really the end of the world or is it your inner critic trying to break you down? When it comes to taming your inner gremlin, try to act like a scientist trying to understand a specimen. Do not approach your situation with an expected outcome. Instead, try to come from a place of wanting to understand better.

Your behaviors — both positive and negative — all stem from your experiences and environment. Take a step back to evaluate how your behaviors are helping or hurting you. This can also help you identify which actions are beneficial and can help you become more neutral in your decisions.

When you take the time to identify your own personal positive traits, you give yourself room to grow and feel more secure in your trading decisions.

Chapter Four: Could Have, Should Have

Your inner critic loves using the phrases like “could have” and “should have.”

When that inner voice speaks up, your best line of defense is self-awareness. To begin building up yours, try this simple technique.

When you have a bad day or make a bad trade, make note of anything that is impacting your mood. Even if it is something that seems trivial, make note of it. The smallest things can have an impact on your emotions and, ultimately, your trading.

For instance, if you have an ongoing problem at home and notice a downturn in your trades, make the connection between your personal feelings and trade performance.

Keeping track of those things will help you identify how those thoughts and feelings are influencing your decisions. More importantly, it impacts how you show up and attack your problems when you go to start trading for the day.

Consider the last time you made a bad trade or did not capitalize on a trading opportunity. How long did you beat yourself up about it? How long did it keep you from moving forward with new trades or how long did the thoughts impact your trade decisions?

Often, traders make one mistake and continue to dwell on it days, weeks, maybe even months later. This way of thinking can and will hold you back from potentially making better trades and progressing in your career. When you have this constant sense of doubt or shame, you will not be able to properly move forward or transform your trading in the ways you probably would like.

So when you are filled with self doubt and these negative feelings, it is important to find a way to get up and out of that rut.

For many traders, it is being able to make a trade, even a small one, that goes into the green. But be careful — “revenge” trading is typically a terrible strategy that can put you even deeper in the hole. So be sure to take the time to trade responsibly — with a well-thought out plan that you intend on following.

For others, it’s stepping away from trading for the day or leaving the office for a bit to get some exercise.

Identifying what can bring you out of this rut can help you get rid of the doubt and self-criticism.

It’s important to have a sense of what puts you in a state of self-doubt, because it can affect more than just your trading. It can seep into your personal life, too. You may feel withdrawn from your family and unable to interact in the way you normally do.

All of these things have a negative impact on you. stems from comparing yourself to others. How can you get past those feelings and get on with your life?

Comparing yourself to others

The grass is always greener, right? But what many people do not realize is that if they took the time to water and nourish their own grass it could be just as green. A lot of those “watering” needs must be tended to from within.

Compare equals despair. Read that again. Write this phrase down on a sticky note and put it where you will see it on a regular basis.

When you compare yourself to others, it leads you to feel like you’re not doing enough. It becomes nearly impossible to not go to a place of despair internally when you are constantly comparing yourself to others.

Begin to notice how often you are comparing yourself. Chances are, it’s a lot. Maybe you’re comparing yourself to another trader on Twitter. Maybe you’re comparing yourself to your neighbor, or your brother, or your friends.

Take note of how often you do this every day. Tally them up and review the number at the end of the day. You will probably be surprised how often you are thinking about someone else’s success instead of your own. When you turn the attention inwards — water your own grass, so to speak — you’ll be better able to break free of your inner critic and start to progress.

Comparing yourself to someone else is almost like sticking your finger in a light socket. It sends a shock through your body, but you are only hurting yourself in the long run. You are not learning anything from the experience. On the contrary, you are actually stopping yourself from learning anything at all.

When you compare yourself to others or get lost in the “could have, should have, would have” cycle, you aren’t helping yourself. You are beating yourself down. You will not get to a place of change and positive transformation by comparing yourself to others or continuing this internal emotional abuse. Instead, it will leave you stagnant and unable to move forward.

From a trading perspective, many people look back at their entries or exits and only see what they could have done differently. Remember — it’s only ever obvious in retrospect.

But so many traders see the success of others and think, “That could have been me.” Essentially, they are just pouring salt in their wounds, which is doing nothing but reinforcing negative thoughts about themselves and their trade decisions.

This constant comparison will always hold you back from reaching your true potential as a trader.

When you stop comparing yourself to others and look at your situation neutrally, you may be surprised at how simple it is to identify what is really important.

One mistake does not define you as a person. It does not define you as a trader. Even the most successful traders have experienced huge losses.

Chapter Five: Trusting Yourself, Not Your Gremlin

Losing is part of being a trader. Everyone loses at some point. You can't control that. But you are in control over how much those losses impact your mind, body and soul.

If you're always focusing on the external, it will be very difficult to gain mastery over how losses impact you. However, if you can shift your focus to your internal process, you can begin to trust yourself instead of your inner critic.

It's a difficult transition to shift to trusting yourself. Most of us have spent our lives letting our inner gremlins take center stage. They tell us whatever they want. It's a difficult transition to shift to trusting yourself.

Yet the benefits are many. Trading decisions often must be made at a fast pace. When you are hung up on your feelings of self doubt, making the swift decisions day trading often requires can be nearly impossible. Self-trust can give you a strong foundation from which to make confident decisions.

Developing self-trust requires a lot of unlearning of negative behaviors. Your approach must leave emotion on the sideline and come from a place of neutrality. This mindset can make a massive difference. Becoming neutral in the situation allows you to approach things from a factual standpoint rather than an emotional one.

More importantly, when you do this, you can start trusting yourself instead of your inner critic. You can identify your feelings and realize that they are not serving you in a positive way. It becomes possible to mute your inner gremlins and say to yourself, “I know what I am doing and even if I make a mistake, I will learn from it” rather than saying, “I messed up before, so I will probably mess this up again.”

Taking a step back and realizing where that negativity stems from will help you kick that inner critic out of its residency in your mind. You can identify those self destructive behaviors and begin to create a go-to plan for dealing with them. Over time, your neutral thinking and new learned behavior will make the voice of your inner gremlins smaller, more of a whisper. Neutral thinking will become the default for you instead of those voices speaking *for* you.

When you are thinking to yourself, “This trade means everything,” it’s probably time to step back and explore the situation from a place of neutrality. Does this trade really mean *the world*? In most cases, it does not. That’s the point at which you are able to consider it neutrally.

When you truly think about the big picture and can step back from the emotions tied into the trade, you can identify what is really important. But it is hard to unlearn this behavior and silence the inner critic.

This one fleeting moment in your trade history will not send your world crashing down. The best thing you can do for yourself and your trades is think about what is next. Whether the trade works or doesn’t work isn’t the issue. Remember, the most successful day traders are continuously moving forward. Their inner saboteur really has no say.

Conclusion

This book is an invitation to get curious about your own personal behavior and to see what you can do to become more neutral in life.

I hope it will inspire you to look for ways to be neutral in your decision-making, trading, and handling day-to-day emotions. Finding that middle-of-the-road place for yourself can help you grow as not only a trader, but as a person.

If you leave reading this with one takeaway it should be this: your inner gremlin is lying to you. You are doing better than you think you are and the emotional ties you have made to your trading are holding you back.

Cut those ties, become neutral in your thinking, and focus on how you can use your strengths to further yourself.

What do you do well and how will you use that to quiet your inner critic?

Did you enjoy this ebook? If so consider the rest of Kim Ann Curtin's ebook series:

Book 2: Deconstructing Greed and Fear of Failure

Fear of failure and greed can lead to taking foolish risks and the erosion of both one's trading account and mental capital. That can lead to a toxic cycle of negative self-talk and reduced self-esteem and self-worth. But did you know that fear of failure and greed are usually symptoms of deeper underlying issues? This book helps traders get to the bottom of these issues in a way that can actually bring about positive change in their trading.

Book 3: Navigating FOMO and Comfort With Loss

How often do you trade because you're afraid of missing out? Many traders are driven by FOMO and unsure of how to get comfortable with loss. In this book, traders will get a better understanding of what's behind the FOMO in their lives and trading. In doing so, they can begin to make changes that can improve their outlook, decision-making, and increase their self-mastery.

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Struggles with discipline and a lack of proven edge are struggles that both new traders and seasoned traders with decades-long careers face. In this book, traders will get insight into why these common struggles persist for so long and learn powerful tools for identifying and working with their own tendencies to gain greater control in their trading and lives.

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